

Now if you are running a high traffic volume site or an app, you can also run an A/B test to check some features. An A/B test means running two different versions of the same feature or layout for different users. Run this test for a few minutes or hours and then analyse the data. Depending on the results, you can decide to make the changes or stick with the original. Remember, you need to run this test only on apps or sites with high traffic to get enough data for it to be meaningful.

If you are launching a new site or app, you can use real time data to understand how the initial users are adopting it. Are they following the route you would like them to take? Are they using the features? What features are being used? Where are the visitors dropping off? What is impeding them from reaching the targeted goal? Using real time tracking, you can improve the site or app to get the best results.

Limitations

Of course, nothing in this world is perfect. Even Google makes mistakes. Before you go ga-ga over real time reports, you should also know that they come with their own challenges. The biggest challenge is that some data points can be delayed. This is due to them being done in batch processing method which means that blocks of data is stored and then processed into the reports in batches. So unfortunately, real time is not always completely real time. Mobile app tracking with real time reports is always processed in batches.

Another issue is traffic source attribution. Sometimes, traffic and conversions are not correctly connected with the actual source in real time reports. This is rectified in the standard report however.

Overall, the limitations of real time tracking outweigh the benefits. Read, understood and used correctly, this report can vastly improve your conversions and marketing ROI. Think of it less as less analysis and more as monitoring. Always return to the standard reports to view the data in posterity and see the impact in depth. **d**